



Argentina



Bolivia



Brazil



Chile

SOUTH AMERICA



Most South Americans are Catholics. A huge statue of Christ towers over the Brazilian port of Rio de Janeiro. This is a reminder of three centuries of European rule, when the first peoples of South America were almost wiped out. Most South Americans still speak Spanish or Portuguese. South America is home to diverse landscapes from the Amazonian rainforests to the Andes and the Galapagos Islands.



Rich and poor

São Paulo, in Brazil, is South America's biggest industrial city. The city center is very modern and wealthy. Many people from the surrounding areas travel to São Paulo in

search of work. Their children often end up living in terrible poverty on the streets.



Galloping gauchos

Large areas of northern and central Argentina are covered with a grassy plain, called the pampas. Huge herds of cattle are kept on the pampas, and are looked after by cowboys known as gauchos. Most gauchos are descendants of European settlers in South America.

These gauchos from northwest Argentina are wearing traditional Spanish hats and neckerchiefs.

Stiff, flared leather flaps protect the gaucho's legs from high-growing thistles when he is riding his horse in the pampas.

Heavy leather riding crop

